

Sudanese Cumin seeds

الكمون السوداني

Cuminum cyminum

Whole, machine-cleaned

Cuminum cyminum L.

Botanical source

Codex Grade II

Grade

0909.31

HS code (indicative)



1 Scope

This sheet specifies whole, uncrushed cumin seeds exported by Asmagh Sudanese Exports from Port Sudan. Ground cumin is supplied to the buyer's specification.

2 Synonyms

Cumin

Kammoun (كمون)

Cuminum cyminum L.

Family Apiaceae (Umbelliferae)

3 Definition

The ripe, dried fruits (commonly called seeds) of *Cuminum cyminum* L., family Apiaceae (Umbelliferae), cleaned and dried.

4 Description

Each fruit is made of two slender half-fruits (mericarps), often separated, about 3–6 mm long, greenish grey to brown. Each half-fruit has five primary ridges and four broader secondary ridges carrying short bristles. Sudanese cumin is grown in the north and valued for its strong aroma.

5 Grade and forms

Clean	Machine-cleaned whole seeds, Codex Grade II
Available as	Whole seedsPowder

6 Uses



7 Requirements

7.1 General requirements

- ✓

A distinct, characteristic aroma and flavour
- ✓

Clean and free from foreign odours, flavours and colours, and especially from mustiness
- ✓

Free from insects at every stage, rodents and their filth
- ✓

Free from caking and traces of mould
- ✓

Free from fertilisers and harmful chemicals

7.2 Technical requirements

	Moisture ≤ 10 % Total ash ≤ 10 % dry basis Acid-insoluble ash ≤ 3 % dry basis Volatile oil ≥ 1.5 ml/100 g dry basis Alcohol-soluble extract ≥ 15 % Foreign matter ≤ 0.5 % sticks, stones, bag fibres, metal Extraneous vegetable matter ≤ 2 % other parts of the cumin plant	Damaged, shrivelled and immature seeds ≤ 3 % Broken seeds ≤ 3 % Insect-damaged seeds ≤ 1.0 % Dead insects, fragments, rodent contamination ≤ 0.5 % Visible mould ≤ 1.0 % Mammalian excreta ≤ 1.0 mg/kg Live insects None
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Percent by mass unless stated. These limits meet Grade II of the Codex Standard for Cumin; the limit for damaged, shrivelled and immature seeds is stricter than Codex (5 %).

7.3 Codex grades for reference

Codex CXS 327-2017	Grade I	Grade II (ours)	Grade III	Ground
Total ash, % dry basis, max	8.5	10.0	12.0	9.5
Acid-insoluble ash, % dry basis, max	1.5	3.0	4.0	1.5
Volatile oil, ml/100 g dry basis, min	2.0	1.5	1.5	1.3
Extraneous vegetable matter, %, max	1	2	3	–
Foreign matter, %, max	0.1	0.5	0.5	–
Insect-damaged matter, %, max	0.5	1.0	1.0	–
Damaged or defective fruits, %, max	5.0	5.0	5.0	–

7.4 Contaminants and hygiene

Mycotoxins and heavy metals	Within the Codex General Standard for Contaminants and Toxins in Food and Feed (CXS 193-1995), including aflatoxins
Pesticide residues	Within the maximum residue limits set by the Codex Alimentarius Commission
Microbiology	Free from <i>Salmonella</i> and <i>E. coli</i> ; handled under the Codex Code of Hygienic Practice for Low-Moisture Foods (CXC 75-2015)
Radioactivity	Within the World Health Organization guidelines

8 Microscopy

Under the microscope, the cumin fruit shows:

Outer skin An epidermis with stomata and a thin, striated cuticle. The ridges carry multicellular bristle hairs with broad bases and rounded tips, larger on the secondary ridges.	Ridges and oil ducts Parenchyma with a fibrovascular bundle beneath each primary ridge. Each half-fruit has four oil ducts (vittae) on its back and two on its flat inner face.	Seed The seed-coat cells each hold a prism of calcium oxalate. The endosperm stores fixed oil and aleurone grains with small rosettes of calcium oxalate.
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9 Packaging

Packed in suitable, clean, dry and closed packages of an approved material that keeps the seeds' properties and neither affects the product nor is affected by it. The label states the handling and storage conditions. Asmagh ships in jute bags of 40 kg.

Container load about 20 MT per 40 ft container.

10 Storage

Stored in a clean, dry, cool place, protected from light and dust.



11 Labelling

Every package carries a clear label showing:

Name of the product  Cumin, with style and grade	Production and expiry date  Month and year	Country of origin  Sudan	Net weight  In kg, metric system
Producer, packer or distributor  Name and address, or trade mark	Code number  Lot identification	Storage instructions  Handling and storage conditions	Writing  Clear and permanent

12 Shelf life

No more than one year from the date of production.

13 Sampling and testing

Samples are taken according to Arab Standard No. 307 (spices and condiments). Tests follow AOAC methods, carried out on that sample in a laboratory approved by the Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO).

Each shipment carries an SSMO analysis and quality certificate.

From field to port

من الحقل إلى الميناء

Every lot is sampled on arrival, machine-cleaned, sorted and tested before it is packed. Storage and loading are checked too, because quality can be lost after processing.

1 Our quality process

1



Sourcing

Bought from growers and traders in northern Sudan; every incoming lot is checked.

2



Cleaning

Machine-cleaned to remove dust, stones, stalks and other plant matter.

3



Sorting

Broken, damaged and immature seeds removed to reach Codex Grade II.

4



Grinding

Ground into powder when the buyer orders ground cumin.

5



Testing

Samples tested for moisture, ash, volatile oil and foreign matter.

6



Packing

Packed in 40 kg jute bags marked with product, lot, weight and storage instructions.

7



Storage

Kept dry, cool and out of the light until loading.

8



Loading and shipping

Containers inspected and loading supervised; shipped from Port Sudan with full documents.

2 Origin and shipping

Sudanese cumin is grown in the north of the country and valued for its strong aroma. The cleaned seed travels to Port Sudan on the Red Sea for export.

HS code	0909.31 (indicative; confirm with your customs broker)
Port of loading	Port Sudan (SDPZU), Red Sea
Container load	About 20 MT per 40 ft container
Ready to load	Usually 10–15 days after contract
Transit	About 2–8 weeks, by destination
Delivery terms	FOB Port Sudan, CFR or CIF
Payment terms	Irrevocable L/C at sight, TT advance, or D/P
Samples	Free; courier paid by the buyer



3 Export documents

Certificates travel with each shipment and are exchanged through the banks or directly with the buyer, so the goods clear customs at destination.

Product certificates



Certificate of origin
Sudan Chamber of Commerce; general or preferential forms.



Phytosanitary certificate
Official inspection against the importing country's pest list.



Analysis and quality certificate
Issued by the Sudanese Standards & Metrology Organization (SSMO).



Fumigation certificate
Treatment, chemical, dose and temperature used.



Inspection certificate
Optional; by an international inspection company chosen by the buyer.

Shipping documents



Export contract
Attested by the Ministry of Trade and the Chamber of Commerce.



Commercial invoice
Goods, quantity, value and terms.



Packing list
Every bag in each container, with counts and weights.



Bill of lading
Issued by the shipping line on loading.

4 Standards and references

- Codex Alimentarius. Standard for cumin, CXS 327-2017.
- Codex Alimentarius. General Standard for Contaminants and Toxins in Food and Feed, CXS 193-1995; Code of Hygienic Practice for Low-Moisture Foods, CXC 75-2015.
- ISO 6465:2009, Cumin (Cuminum cyminum L) — Specification.
- Syrian Arab Standard SNS 828/2010, Whole and ground cumin.
- Arab Standard No. 307, Spices and condiments — Sampling.
- British Herbal Pharmacopoeia (1996); European Pharmacopoeia, 3rd edition (1996).



Request a quote or a sample

Tell us whole or ground, the quantity and destination port, and our team will come back to you with an offer.

asmagh.com

Khartoum, Sudan. Loading at Port Sudan.

